

Agnieszka Besz

engineering & technology leader — consumer products & real-time systems

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ABOUT

I'm an engineering leader with more than a decade of experience building consumer software used by millions of people, most of it real-time and mobile. At Decentraland I run engineering for a large open-source social platform: I own the technology strategy and budget, negotiate vendor contracts, and led a ground-up rebuild of our main consumer application, now the primary client in production. I grew the team from a handful of engineers into an organisation with its own managers and QA, and built the hiring process and career ladder behind it. I lead with data rather than opinion, care a lot about reliability and how fast we ship, use AI as a normal part of how we work, and I still read the code.

WORK EXPERIENCE

VP of Engineering — Decentraland, London

2025 — Present

- Led the ground-up rebuild of the platform's main consumer application, replacing a legacy web client with a modular, open-source desktop app that is now the primary client in production.
- Set technical direction and OKRs, using telemetry to decide what we build, what we cut, and what comes first.
- Owned the technology budget and negotiated licensing and contracts with our main platform vendor (Unity).
- Expanded distribution to new channels, added code-signed builds, and improved installer, onboarding, and update reliability.
- Grew engineering from a single team of ~5 into multiple teams with engineering managers and QA leads. Built the hiring process, career ladder, and performance reviews.
- Made AI a normal part of the engineering process: AI review on every PR, AI-assisted QA, and adoption across teams. I use it daily in my own analysis.
- Shipped ~75 public releases a year, weekly or faster, with crash reporting, hang detection, and automated performance tests gating every PR.

Engineering Manager — Decentraland, London

2022 — 2025

- Grew the client team from ~5 to 10+ engineers and led the rebuild that replaced the legacy web client, including the new application's architecture.
- Owned the product's strategic KPIs (loading time, stability, responsiveness) and the tech-debt program behind them.
- Changed how the team shipped: a predictable cadence, monitoring, and a QA bar every release had to clear.

Head of Frontend Development — Ten Square Games

2021 — 2022

- Engineering leadership for a 45+ person technology department across seven live consumer products.
- Grew the department from ~25 to 45+ engineers during a major growth phase.
- Modernized lifecycle tooling and drove adoption of shared libraries across teams, so every team could iterate faster.

Technical Manager — Rovio (now Sega), Helsinki

2019 — 2021

- Led development of a new mobile product (Angry Birds Journey) from concept to soft launch and managed, mentored, and grew the programming team behind it.

Senior Software Engineer — Next Games (now Netflix), Helsinki

2017 — 2019

- Core systems, new features, and live-operations engineering on two live mobile products with large audiences (Stranger Things: Puzzle Tales, The Walking Dead: No Man's Land).

Associate Lead Programmer → Programmer — Ubisoft RedLynx, Helsinki

2015 — 2017

- Built core systems, real-time synchronous multiplayer, and UI for a live mobile product (South Park: Phone Destroyer); led performance optimization and a small team of programmers.

Earlier roles

2012 — 2015

- Turku University of Applied Sciences — Lecturer / Project Engineer; INTERMARUM — Programmer; Kiwi Flying Mad — Programmer & Co-founder of an indie studio.

EDUCATION

Doctoral studies (not completed), Computer Science — Turku & Opole Univ. of Technology (2013 – 2015)

MSc, Computer Science — Opole University of Technology (2012 – 2013)

BSc, Computer Science — Opole University of Technology (2008 – 2012); exchange year at Vaasa UAS, Finland

LEADERSHIP

- Strategy & OKRs
- Budget & cost ownership
- Vendor & partner management
- Cross-functional leadership
- Distribution / go-to-market
- Org design, hiring & performance mgmt

TECHNICAL

- Consumer apps at scale
- Reliability & observability
- Performance optimization
- Release engineering & CI/CD
- Real-time systems
- AI in engineering workflows

TOOLS

- C# / Unity
- Git & GitHub CI/CD
- Sentry, Grafana
- Jira, Notion, Slack

LANGUAGES

- Polish (native)
- English (professional)
- Finnish (elementary)

RECOGNITION

DirectX 11 Competition

Best Pitch — Startup Journey Demo Day

3 publications (mobile AR, driving-inspection tooling, shooting-sports apps)